PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Steyr-Puch Pinzgauer 716 / 718

1985–2007 · 716 · 718 · Turbo D

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Buy the complete one**
  A UK specialist's first rule is to get the truck with everything fitted, because spares are never easy. Another veteran owner says to plan on buying two: a replacement diff can cost as much as some trucks sell for.
- [ ] **Test the diff locks and low range**
  Operate every switch and lever and make sure the diff locks engage and release, and that low range works. Lazy unlocking usually points to the air system: heat-damaged lines near the exhaust, a leaking lock box, or a sticky valve under the centre dash.
- [ ] **Check the 716's rear air spring**
  On a 716, disconnect the level control arm, push it fully up, run the engine above 1,800 rpm and check that the air bag inflates within about 30 seconds. A 716 that sits on its tail in the morning has a leak. The parts are expensive.
- [ ] **Autos: watch the first-to-second shift cold**
  The ZF 4HP22 is generally reliable. Its best-known fault is sticking in first when cold, usually from a contaminated governor. Also check for harsh or slipping shifts, a worn park brake and a disconnected breather.
- [ ] **Look for oil where it shouldn't be**
  Check the axle tubes and yellow swivel boots for leaks, the portals for weeping seals, and the engine for valve-cover, rear cam seal and oil-cooler leaks. Look in the coolant too: oil there points first to the oil cooler, then to the head gasket.
- [ ] **Listen at speed and from cold**
  Start it from cold and look for smoke and leaks. Big miles can mean a tired rear diff, which whines at speed. Higher mileage alone isn't a big worry for the VW engine, which is relatively easy to source parts for.
- [ ] **Work out the year and build**
  International VINs have no model year, so titles and insurers can get it wrong. The chassis number (last digits) and the transmission and transfer-case plates are better guides, and only a build certificate from the factory is definitive.
- [ ] **Check the paperwork before you pay**
  Ex-military trucks were never certified for US roads, and some states treat them differently. A Colorado DMV clerk flagged a Pinzgauer VIN as military in 2022, and owners say California is especially hard. Buy one already titled in your state, or ask your DMV first.

YEARS TO KNOW

P80 (to chassis 1790)	BEWARE	Original spec: small nose, no intercooler, cooling versions A and B. Owners say the earlier TDs were known to run hot, and later trucks got a revised cooling

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **716/718 vs 710/712**
  The Turbo D has a bulged radiator nose, disc brakes and a 5×130 wheel pattern. The petrol 710/712 has a flatter front, drums and a different bolt pattern, and few drivetrain parts interchange.
- [ ] **P80, P90 or P93**
  Look at the nose: the P80 has the smallest radiator cover, and it grew with the P90 and P93. P93s have an intercooler. Some P80s were factory-upgraded to P90 spec; one importer says trucks upgraded outside the factory have cowls cut by hand to clear the radiator hoses.
- [ ] **VIN**
  Pinzgauers use the international 17-digit VIN with the WMI VAG, for example VAG71623110001645 on a 1990 716K. The model number follows the WMI. Position 10 means left-hand drive (1) or right-hand drive (2), not the model year, which confuses US insurers. The last digits are the chassis number.
- [ ] **Build year**
  No model year is stamped on a 716 or 718. The transmission and transfer-case data plates sometimes carry a date (for those parts only). A build certificate from the factory is the only definitive record.
- [ ] **Ex-US special-ops 718**
  US military trucks were P90s or upgraded P80s with lever-action ignition switches; some had a control for a crawler reduction box. Ask for the surplus sale paperwork.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/pinzgauer/pinzgauer-716-718/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks